

■ By Kimi Dangor

Fashion is falling to new lengths. While ateliers stop postulating on the *veni, vidi, vici* of rivalries and start deliberating on the mini, midi, maxi, the couture circus is ushering in a sizzling new season of spring-summer fancy.

Yes, the midi is back. Fashion is in flashback mode as maxis also follow suit. So lengths fall and spirits grow lighter. The upcoming spring-summer lines from designers are playful, colourful, inspired by art—a welcome

change from the monochromatic musings from fall-winter—as the Wills Lifestyle India Fashion Week (WIFW) returns with a tenth edition and a fresh round of fashion, fusion and friction at Delhi's Pragati Maidan between September 5 and 9.

And the one trend that is set to sweep the ramp is the Marlene Dietrich throwback, gripped in Hollywood glamour galore—the full-length dress—harkening back to a time when fanciful was fun. From Rohit Bal's eclectic Turkey-inspired drawing board to Ranna Gill's playful but poised touch and Gauri & Nainika Karan's feather-light fantasy, this new length lightens the mood.

For Bal, "inspiration struck during a summer holiday in Turkey". While his twin finale collections, *Intertwined* and *Syahi*, inspired by the ancient styles of Iznik in Turkey, play on stripes and ostrich bouffants, his full-length dresses give glamour a new twist. Gill, on the other hand, teams the flirtatious with the sophisticated in her Cuba-inspired collection *Havana*, which yo-yos from full-length slinky dresses to the itchy-bitsy bikini.

PRINT MATTER

From floral and graphic patterns to polka dots, prints run riot on clothes this spring-summer.

Ranna Gill's geometric and paisley saga, *Havana*, makes for a perfect sun-downer.

SPRINGING A SURPRISE

Lengths fall and spirits bounce as couture becomes cute, but will there be fusion or confusion at the year's third fashion week?



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